

MOLECULAR DYNAMICS EVALUATION OF MECHANISTIC PROPERTIES DRIVING PASSIVE PERMEATION IN BINARY BILAYERS

Taoufiq BOURAKADI¹, Mehdi BENMAMERI², Patrick TROUILLAS^{1,2,3}, Gabin FABRE¹

¹ INSERM U1248 Pharmacology & Transplantation, Faculty of Pharmacy, University of Limoges, 87000 Limoges, France; ² InSilibio, 1 avenue Ester Technopôle, 87069 Limoges, France; ³ Regional Centre of Advanced Technologies and Materials, The Czech Advanced Technology and Research Institute (CATRIN), Palacký University Olomouc, Šlechtitelů 27, 779 00 Olomouc, Czech Republic
(corresponding author: gabin.fabre@unilim.fr)

Keywords: permeation, drug, lipid composition, molecular dynamics

ABSTRACT

While passive permeation is important for pharmacokinetics, the thermodynamic impact of biological membrane complexity remains poorly mapped. We systematically evaluated how lipid bilayer composition shapes the free energy profiles of six diverse drug-like xenobiotics (amantadine, diclofenac, metoprolol, pindolol, ranitidine, scopolamine). Using the MemCross all-atom molecular dynamics (MD) protocol¹ and Accelerated Weight Histogram (AWH) method, we simulated permeation across five binary lipid mixtures representative of human plasma membranes.

Our findings reveal that permeation thermodynamics are co-driven by specific lipid structural features and the intrinsic molecular properties of the permeants. We developed multivariate models capable of predicting key thermodynamic parameters based on mechanistic descriptors quickly obtainable from MD simulations.

REFERENCES

- 1 Benmameri, M.; Chantemargue, B.; Humeau, A.; Trouillas, P.; Fabre, G. MemCross: Accelerated Weight Histogram Method to Assess Membrane Permeability. *Biochimica et Biophysica Acta (BBA) - Biomembranes* 2023, 1865 (3), 184120. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bbamem.2023.184120>.